

Adam Hickey

Senior Product Designer · Enterprise product strategy · UX · Design systems · AI-supported decision workflows
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Professional summary

Senior product designer with 20 years in complicated enterprise software, for organizations like Cargill, Intel, CBRE and Toro. Thirteen of them were at RBA, where most of the last decade went to design systems: structural audits, the token and component architecture underneath, and the governance that keeps them alive. More recently I define, design and build products and prototypes myself, from product strategy through to a working front end. My current focus is the design problem inside AI-supported software: what an operator has to understand about a recommendation before acting on it, how confidence and constraints get expressed, and what the interface owes someone on the occasions the system is wrong.

Experience

Selected Independent Work — Product design, systems, prototyping 2026 – Present

- Product definition, design, systems and prototyping for complicated software, from ambiguity through to something a team can react to.
- Dispatch cockpit — a working prototype of AI-assisted load assignment: the factors behind a recommendation rather than a score, confidence expressed operationally, a one-click override that teaches, and the manual path left fully intact.
- Lucy Learns — an offline-first training app defined, designed and built end to end, with AI coding tools driven from a terminal rather than a chat window.
- Door County Found — a regional travel guide where every place is structured data rather than a blog post. Defined, designed and built end to end, including the editing workflow.

RBA Inc — Lead UX Product Designer 2013 – 2026

- Led enterprise product design and UX strategy for clients in manufacturing, healthcare, financial services, and the public sector, including compliance-sensitive work for a federal agency, a regional bank and healthcare providers.
- Tied design decisions to the numbers product, engineering and business teams already track: efficiency, adoption, quality, ROI.
- Built and governed design systems across SAP, Microsoft, Umbraco, and Sitecore platforms: tokens, component libraries, contribution rules and release checkpoints. Led accessibility, DesignOps and governance practices.
- Used AI to scale the design system: drafting documentation, auditing for drift, checking design against code, and pulling research together. Human judgment on every decision.

Selected projects

- Scaling enterprise product design across 40+ SAP applications: one design system and accessibility standard, about a third less time from design to development, and UI defects in production cut roughly in half.
- Sprout, a design system for Cargill: tokens in the code, mirrored as Figma variables under a written sync contract, and packaged as a Claude Code skill.
- Cutting operational overhead 80% with a USDA grant-management portal (research, workflows, accessibility).
- Orchestrating real-time logistics for a 450+ truck fleet: cockpit UI, fleet visibility and the decision surface itself, for a dispatcher who is short on attention rather than short on data.

Core capabilities

Product Strategy · Product Definition · Complex Workflows · UX & Interaction Design · Information Architecture · Research & Usability · Design Systems, Tokens & Governance · Accessibility · Rapid Prototyping · Design-to-Code Workflows · Data-Dense & Decision-Support Interfaces · AI-Supported Decision Workflows · Explainability & Appropriate Trust

Design tools & platforms

Figma/FigJam (variables, Dev Mode, component libraries) · Claude & Claude Code (skills, plugins, MCP) · ChatGPT & Gemini · CSS custom properties (tokens) · HTML/CSS/JavaScript · Playwright · Git/GitHub · SAP Fiori · Sitecore · Umbraco · WCAG 2.1 AA

Education

Bachelor of Science in Graphic Design, University of Minnesota–Twin Cities (2005)

Prior professional experience

Pixel Farm — Interactive Designer / Developer Jan 2008 – Apr 2013

Shipped two native iOS apps and an iPad app, plus configurator and store-locator builds for Lund Boats and Fulton Beer. Built front-end experiences in HTML, CSS and jQuery across Joomla! and WordPress; led rebrands and visual identity systems.

LEVEL — Interactive Designer Jan 2006 – Jan 2008

Designed and built front-end websites in HTML, CSS, and Flash with project managers, creative leads, writers, and developers.

ByDesign — Graphic Designer Jan 2005 – Jan 2006